

Fall home maintenance checklist

Use what applies. Follow equipment instructions and local guidance.

Start indoors

- ☐ **Arrange a heating-system check-up.**
Book a qualified contractor before you need the heat regularly. ENERGY STAR recommends pre-season professional maintenance.
- ☐ **Inspect the HVAC filter.**
Confirm the correct size and type; follow manufacturer guidance for cleaning or replacement. Continue monthly inspections.
- ☐ **Test smoke alarms.**
Follow the manufacturer's procedure. Keep monthly tests on your calendar and check the alarms' manufacture dates.
- ☐ **Check carbon monoxide alarm instructions.**
Record the required testing schedule and replacement date for each device. Ask your local fire department if coverage is unclear.
- ☐ **Notice drafts and damaged seals.**
Make a list of accessible window and door seals that need attention. Use materials and methods suitable for the home; do not block required ventilation.

Plan the outdoor work

- ☐ **Review gutters and downspouts.**
From the ground, look for obvious blockages, overflow marks, or disconnected sections. Arrange safe cleaning or repairs where needed.
- ☐ **Look at where rainwater goes.**
Note pooling or drainage toward the building and discuss persistent problems with a professional.
- ☐ **Plan hose and outdoor-faucet care.**
Where freezing is possible, follow the fixture manufacturer's and local utility's winterization guidance.
- ☐ **Schedule irrigation winterization if needed.**
Use the system instructions or a qualified irrigation contractor. Do not improvise compressed-air procedures.
- ☐ **Check visible exterior damage.**
Record loose or damaged materials seen from the ground. Get qualified help for roof, electrical, structural, or hard-to-reach work.

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Finish with a plan

- ☐ **Check appliance manuals for seasonal care.**
Add applicable tasks for the systems you own; avoid a universal service interval for every appliance.
- ☐ **Review the next three months of warranties.**
Find the written coverage terms and service contact before setting a reminder.
- ☐ **Update storm or outage supplies for your area.**
Use your local emergency-management guidance for the hazards and household needs that apply.
- ☐ **Write down completed work and outstanding jobs.**
Include the date, service provider, and next step. Keep postponed work separate from completed work.
- ☐ **Back up your home records.**
Save a current copy somewhere you can find later and check that the exported file opens.

Next task / date: _____

Planning prompts, not a home inspection or repair procedure. Use qualified help for electrical, gas, structural, and work-at-height tasks.

Sources checked September 18, 2026: ENERGY STAR maintenance checklist; U.S. Fire Administration smoke alarms; EPA WaterSense finding leaks. Links are in the online guide.